NATIONAL DISEASE INTERVENTION CERTIFICATION PROJECT: CERTIFIED IN DISEASE INTERVENTION (CDI)

PROJECT BACKGROUND

Disease Intervention (DI) professionals are a vital part of the national public health workforce. They work directly in communities to prevent and mitigate the spread of infectious diseases such as sexually transmitted infections (STIs), HIV, COVID-19, viral hepatitis, and tuberculosis (TB). National certification programs play an essential role in validating professional knowledge, skills, and abilities, ensuring individuals meet established standards of proficiency and professionalism. Such certification not only enhances service quality but also supports workforce expansion and retention.

The National Disease Intervention Certification Project is a collaborative initiative led the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) through CK20-2003, "Improving Clinical and Public Health Outcomes through National Partnerships to Prevent and Control Emerging Infectious Disease Threats." The CDC in collaboration with the Association for Schools and Programs of Public Health (ASPPH), and the certification provider, National Board of Public Health Examiners (NBPHE) are implementing the Certified in Disease Intervention (CDI) program.

CDI PROJECT HISTORY

With funding from the CDC, support for professional certification for the disease intervention workforce has and continues to involve stakeholders who have shaped this project over time:

PHASE 1
FEASIBILITY

In 2013, a feasibility study was conducted by International Credentialing Associates (ICA) and National Association of County and City Health Officers (NACCHO).

NACCHO
National Association of County & City Health Officials

PHASE 2
ASSESSMENT

In 2014, the Public Health Accreditation Board (PHAB) determined the foundational activities for a national Disease Intervention Certification program:

- Definition of a Disease Intervention Professional
- Job Task Analysis of the Disease Intervention workforce
- Enumeration of the Disease Intervention Workforce

PHAB

PHASE 3
DEVELOPMENT

By convening national partners and engaging subject matter experts, the Association of Schools and Programs of Public Health (ASPPH) is developing educational pathways that remove barriers to the CDI exam to recruit, train, and retain the disease intervention workforce. In 2022, in collaboration with the National Board of Public Health Examiners (NBPHE), ASPPH began work towards:

- Disease Intervention Workforce Environmental Scan
- Updated Job Task Analysis (JTA) of the Disease Intervention Workforce
- CDI Examination and Certification program development
- CDI Continuing Education program development

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PROJECT OVERVIEW

ASPPH, in collaboration with the certification provider, NBPHE, is currently developing the voluntary certification program, Certified in Disease Intervention (CDI). The CDI Program is for disease intervention professionals to enhance clinical and public health outcomes through national partnerships. The CDI Program aims to:

- Standardize and validate the knowledge, skills, and abilities of DI professionals.
- Enhance the quality and consistency of service delivery.
- Support the recruitment, training, and retention of a diverse disease intervention workforce.
- Strengthen pathways from educational institutions to career opportunities and certification.

By providing a high-quality, standardized approach to professional development, the CDI Program seeks to ensure that DI professionals are well-equipped to respond to emerging and re-emerging infectious disease threats, ultimately improving public health services across communities.

COMING SOON

DISEASE INTERVENTION JOB TASK ANALYSIS SURVEY

An important step in developing a national Certified in Disease Intervention (CDI) Program is performing a job task analysis. **A job task analysis** involves systematically identifying and documenting the specific responsibilities associated with a particular job or role within an organization to inform certification examination development. The disease intervention job task analysis includes the following domains:

1. Collaboration
2. Field Services and Outreach Activities
3. Interviewing and Case Management Activities
4. Outbreak Response and Emergency Management
5. Planning and Case Analysis
6. Surveillance and Data Collection

Learn more about the job task analysis **here**.

The Association of Schools and Programs of Public Health (ASPPH)
ASPPH represents more than 150 accredited schools and programs of public health and mobilizes the collective power of its members to drive excellence and innovation in public health education, research, and practice. The ASPPH Center for Public Health Workforce Development brings together academia, members of the public health workforce, and the communities in which they serve to develop and strengthen the public health workforce to protect and promote the health of all people in all populations.
Please click here for more information about ASPPH

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